On what basis FieldNote recommends.

A recommendation is only worth trusting if you can see how it was reached. Every card is scored on four axes, then mapped to an action by a fixed rule. Nothing rests on opinion or a vendor's press release.

1 · Evidence grade — how well substantiated

A	Independent production evidence — named organisation, method, measurable result. Language: "observed in production".
B	Named customer case study or credible research with clear methodology. Language: "reported / associated with".
C	Vendor documentation, release notes or sponsored study. Language: "vendor states".
D	Demo, announcement or unverified secondary report. Language: "early signal, not verified".

2 · Verified outcome — what actually happened

The vendor's claim is checked against outcomes FieldNote has tracked across real pilots. The gap between claim and verified reality is itself the intelligence — and the proprietary asset a summary can't reproduce.

3 · Fit to your business

Does it address a stated priority, and are the conditions where it works present at your company? A strong average outcome with poor fit is still the wrong bet.

4 · Complexity & risk

Implementation effort, downside exposure and reversibility.

The decision rule

ADOPT	Strong evidence (A/B) + consistent positive verified outcome + good fit + low downside.
PILOT	Positive but variable outcome, or strong fit on a high-effort response — prove it in your context against a control before rollout.
INVESTIGATE	Real potential on vendor-grade (C) evidence — get methodology and references, then a small controlled test.
WATCH	Weak evidence or a negative track record — do not act; the downside outweighs the upside.

Note: pilot counts and verified figures in this sample dossier are illustrative. In production they are drawn from FieldNote's tracked-outcomes ledger, which accrues with every customer pilot.

VENDOR DEMO · 15 SEP 2026

Generative tool auto-writes SEO summaries at scale

Recommend: Watch — don't chase | **Evidence D** | Content ops

Why Watch: Grade-D evidence and a negative track record (6 of 18 penalised; net traffic flat-to-negative) → the downside outweighs the upside. A summary would have sold you this; the outcomes data says avoid it.

CLAIM → VERIFIED

~~Vendor: "3× organic traffic"~~ → **Of 18 tracked, 6 hit by search penalties within 6 months; net traffic flat-to-negative**

WHAT HAPPENED	Bulk-generates summaries and landing pages — a cheap-traffic play with real quality and brand risk.
TRACK RECORD	The cheap-traffic play backfired more often than it worked — the reason this is graded "watch, don't chase". Best fit: only as human-assisted editing, never unattended.
COMPANY RELEVANCE	Tempting as a P1 traffic-recovery shortcut, but it risks a search penalty on the very domain your revenue depends on.
KEY RISKS	Search penalties · brand damage · commodity content.
SUCCESS MEASURES	Editor time saved · engagement · penalty incidents.
EVIDENCE & SOURCES	Vendor demo only — not independently verified.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Do not deploy for unattended publishing. Re-evaluate only if independent, penalty-free production evidence emerges. Meanwhile, direct the same effort at Use case 2 (first-party audience).